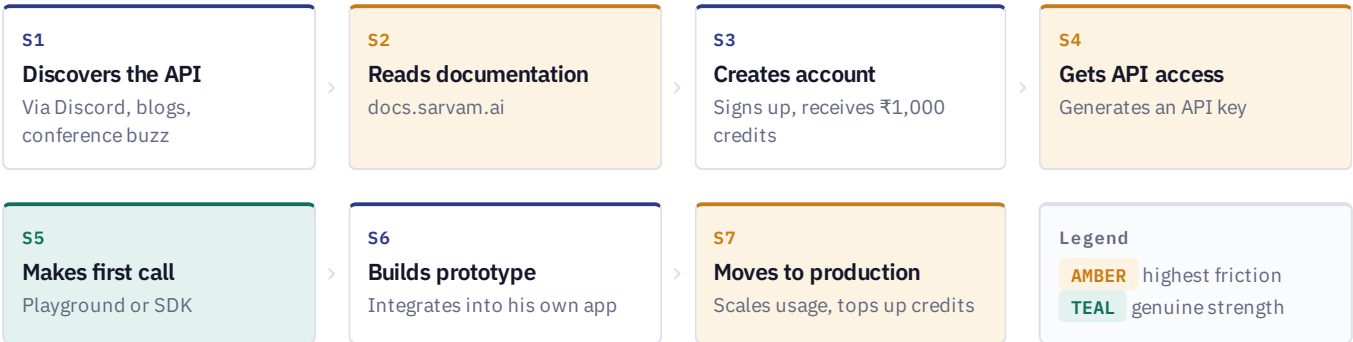


Product Teardown

One real, high-value journey — a developer discovering and adopting Sarvam's API — dissected stage by stage for friction, with severity assigned to each finding.

JOURNEY	STAGES EXAMINED	FRICTION POINTS FOUND	RATED HIGH SEVERITY
Developer onboarding	7	6	2

9.1 The journey mapped



9.2 Stage 2 — Reads documentation

ISSUE TYPE	FINDING
Confusion	Sarvam offers six or more distinct API products — chat/LLM, Saaras ASR, Bulbul TTS, Translation, Sarvam Vision OCR, and video localisation. A developer arriving with a vague need ("I want voice in my app") has no single guided entry point and must self-diagnose which APIs he needs.
Missing information	There is no prominent "if your use case is X, use API Y" decision aid on the docs homepage. The information architecture is organised by <i>product</i> , not by <i>use case</i> .
Opportunity	A use-case selector at the top of the docs — "Building a voice bot?" / "Digitising documents?" / "Translating content?" — would cut decision time substantially.

9.3 Stage 3 — Creates account

ISSUE TYPE	FINDING
Trust barrier	The ₹1,000 free credit is generous, but it is not immediately clear how many API calls that actually buys . Without a translation into real units — hours of speech, thousands of tokens — the ambiguity quietly reduces signup-to-try conversion.
Opportunity	A credit estimator shown at signup ("₹1,000 gets you roughly X minutes of speech-to-text or Y chat messages") would improve perceived value instantly, at near-zero engineering cost.

9.4 Stage 4 — Gets API access

ISSUE TYPE	FINDING
Friction	Enterprise-grade rate limits and volume discounts require emailing a team rather than a self-serve upgrade. That is reasonable for genuine enterprise deals, but it also blocks fast-scaling startups who are not yet "enterprise" from getting the limits they need quickly.
Opportunity	A self-serve startup tier sitting between free / pay-as-you-go and full enterprise contact-us would reduce this drop-off without cannibalising real enterprise deals.

9.5 Stage 5 — Makes first API call

ISSUE TYPE	FINDING
Strength	The public claim of a first request in under five minutes, a Playground for no-setup testing, and <code>/11ms.txt</code> plus per-page <code>.md</code> support show genuine developer empathy. This is a real strength, not a gap , and should be protected in any redesign.
Confusion (minor)	With multiple model variants in play — Sarvam-30B vs. 105B, Bulbul V3 vs. the newly announced V4, Saaras V3 — a first-time caller may not know which <i>version</i> to call without reading changelogs closely.

9.6 Stage 6 — Builds prototype

ISSUE TYPE	FINDING
Missing information	No in-dashboard usage analytics are referenced in public materials — for example "your app made X calls with a Y% success rate." Without this, developers cannot self-diagnose issues. <i>Inferred from available documentation rather than confirmed absent; worth validating directly in-product.</i>
Opportunity	A lightweight usage dashboard with a success and error breakdown per API would reduce support-ticket load and increase developer confidence at the same time.

9.7 Stage 7 — Moves to production

ISSUE TYPE	FINDING
Conversion barrier	The jump from self-serve pay-as-you-go to enterprise-grade SLAs and support is a "contact us" wall . There is no visible mid-tier — no paid "Growth" plan with a defined SLA — for scaling startups who need more than free-tier support but are not ready for an enterprise contract.
Opportunity	Introduce a self-serve "Scale" plan with defined uptime commitments and priority support, purchasable without a sales conversation.

9.8 Consolidated friction summary

FRICTION	STAGE AFFECTED	SEVERITY
Too many APIs, no use-case router	Documentation — S2	HIGH
No mid-tier SLA plan before "contact sales"	Production — S7	HIGH
Unclear real-world value of free credits	Signup — S3	MEDIUM
No self-serve startup tier between free and enterprise	API access — S4	MEDIUM

Friction	Stage Affected	Severity
Limited visible usage analytics	Prototype — S6	MEDIUM
Model and version selection ambiguity	First call — S5	LOW-MEDIUM

THE SINGLE SENTENCE THIS TEARDOWN PRODUCES

Developers are forced to do Sarvam's product-matching work for it, before they have experienced any value — and the ones who succeed anyway then hit a wall with nowhere to upgrade to. Those two findings drive the redesign in **Section 10** and the prioritisation in **Section 11**.